



Sink or Swim?

By Anna Kirschberg



Book Summary

This non-fiction book looks at different animals and how they swim. This book contains vibrant, diverse and modern photography. Features of the Book – Phase 4 Blends; sm, sw. The text will introduce the reader to new consonant blends.

This book follows the Beanstalk Books (Letters & Sounds) Phase 4 progression and focuses on teaching blending and segmentation of adjacent consonant blends.

Skills and Strategies

This book builds on decodable reading strategies for high/low readers. The book has been written using a strictly controlled vocabulary. Text uses only **decodable regular words** (according to the week by week progression of Letters & Sounds) along with 'Heart Words' or 'Common Exception Words' (CEWs). Heart Words are frequently used words that are not decodable at this phase.

Phase 4 - Blends

CVCC (nd mp nt, nk ft st, lt lk sk)	CCVC (fr br, cr tr, gr dr pr)
CCVC (pl bl gl, sl fl cl, st sp sn, sm sw)	CCVCC (short vowel)
CVCC CCVC CCVCC (long vowel)	CCCVC CVCCC

Heart Words:

the, to, of, are, you, they, like, do, have, some, elephants

This book also supports other key reading strategies:

- Recognising the relationship between words and images;
- Pointing one-to-one at each word to ensure an appropriate match;
- Vocabulary and word study.

This book also supports key comprehension strategies:

- Making connections between prior knowledge and the text;
- Summarising the main ideas.

This book also supports non-fiction strategies:

- Gaining information from photographs;
- Encountering curriculum related terms and concepts.

Introducing the Text

Open up the discussion about the front cover image and make connections with the children's prior knowledge of this topic. Prompt discussions by using the vocabulary in the book.

What does the title of the book tell you about the front cover image?

What do you already know about this topic?

Read the title and the name of the author to the group. Read aloud the featured heart words from each phase, from the front inner cover.

Reading the Text

Pages 2 and 3 – Explain where to begin reading, and ask the student to point to each word as you read aloud together. Sound out the individual letter sounds as you go, for example: 'swim' = /s/w/i/m/ and 'sink' = /s/i/n/k/. Where are the adjacent consonant blends located in these words?

Pages 4 and 5 – In these photographs, describe what you can see in the images and review the text together. Identify the words that feature blends such as ‘chimps’ with the ‘-mp’ ending blend.

Pages 6 and 7 – Here, the reader will encounter additional consonant blends in words like ‘blink’. Identify the featured consonant blend. Sound out the letter sounds as you go. Can you think of any other words that contain the ‘bl-’ beginning blend?

Page 8 – Describe what the photograph on the final page is showing. Are there any re-featured or new blends on this page?

Children can now read the book independently.

At the end of the book, go over the text and photographs again and discuss what is happening on each page.

Revisiting the Text

As a group, refer back to the table in the front inner cover and identify the words in the book that use some of the new consonant blends being taught in Phase 4. Identify as many new blends as you can in words in the text.

Look at the use of punctuation in the story. Can you find the pages with a question mark in the text?

Are there any new ‘heart words’ featured?

Following Up

Use the BLM for this story, the students can learn more about the different types of consonant blends being used in the text of the story.